

2019 BECE English Language Past Questions

– Paper One

1. One of the bulls.....from the herd.

- A. have been strayed
- B. has been strayed
- C. have strayed
- D. has strayed

2. I saw the dog.....out of the house.

- A. run
- B. is running
- C. ran
- D. was running

3. Habib goes to school.....train.

- A. by
- B. on
- C. with
- D. in

4. This phone is not mine; it is

- A. mine uncle's
- B. my uncle's
- C. my uncles
- D. mine uncle

5. Their sister wore a dress to the party.

- A. silk blue beautiful
- B. beautiful blue silk
- C. blue beautiful silk
- D. beautiful silk blue

6. I wish I my friend next week.

- A. can visit
- B. am visiting
- C. shall visit
- D. could visit

7. Aba took her mother in many ways.

- A. after
- B. up
- C. on
- D. by

8. That girl is allergic dust.

- A. with
- B. to
- C. against
- D. about

9. My brother, with his children, travelling to Salaga next week.

- A. is
- B. are
- C. was
- D. were

10. It is high time we for the meeting.

- A. left
- B. leave
- C. have to leave
- D. will leave

11. The accused person refused to appear before the panel.

- A. five-man's
- B. five-man
- C. five-men
- D. five-mens

12. The stories her children told her made her

- A. to laugh
- B. laughing
- C. laughed
- D. laugh

13. They have not bought of the two prescribed books.

- A. neither
- B. either
- C. none
- D. all

14. The boy found the assignment to do.

- A. much too difficult
- B. difficult too much
- C. too much difficult
- D. much difficult too

15. The oxen lay on the bare floor,?

- A. didn't they
- B. don't they
- C. didn't it
- D. isn't it

Choose from the alternatives lettered A to D the one which is nearest in meaning to the underlined word in each sentence.

16. The officials made a sudden visit to the school.

- A. an unusual
- B. a strange
- C. a quick
- D. an unexpected

17. Some of the students grumbled about the assignment.

- A. questioned
- B. talked
- C. complained
- D. bothered

18. It is impolite to talk loudly in the presence of the elderly.

- A. incorrect
- B. improper
- C. unwise
- D. rude

19. She is fond of talking about trivial matters.

- A. unpleasant
- B. unimportant
- C. unexciting
- D. unacceptable

20. This curious child likes to ask a lot of questions.

- A. inquisitive
- B. pompous
- C. intelligent
- D. talkative

In each of the following sentences, a group of words has been underlined. Choose from the alternatives lettered A to D the one that best explains the underlined group of words.

21. Araba's visit was a bolt from the blue. This means that the visit was

- A. a most welcome one
- B. short
- C. a complete surprise
- D. timely

22. My uncle loves to cast his bread upon the waters. This means that my uncle

- A. behaves strangely
- B. feeds his fish with bread
- C. is wasteful
- D. loves to help people

23. When he lost his job, Taro was left to sink or swim. This means that my uncle

- A. was depressed
- B. shouted for help
- C. had to find another job
- D. had to survive on his own

24. I was informed at the eleventh hour about his decision to leave. This means that I heard about his decision

- A. immediately
- B. at eleven o'clock
- C. in good time
- D. very late

25. John had to eat his words when our team won the match. This means that John

- A. became very much surprised
- B. admitted he was wrong
- C. denied all that he had said
- D. lost appetite

From the list of words lettered A to D, choose the one that is most nearly opposite in meaning to the word underlined in each sentence.

26. The girl intentionally tore her dress.

- A. carelessly
- B. accidentally
- C. willingly
- D. foolishly

27. We initiated several projects last year.

- A. funded
- B. completed
- C. executed
- D. organized

28. Most of the rules were observed.

- A. violated
- B. cancelled
- C. lessened
- D. excluded

29. The results will be released very soon

- A. withheld
- B. confirmed
- C. withdrawn
- D. canceled

30. No one enjoyed the old man's humourless stories.

- A. funny
- B. peculiar
- C. familiar
- D. cheerful

Objective Answers

1 D. has strayed

2 A. run

3 A. by

4 B. my uncle's

5 B. beautiful blue silk

6 D. could visit

7 A. after

8 B. to

9 A. is

10 A. left

11 B. five-man

12 D. laugh

13 B. either

14 A. much too difficult

15 A. didn't they

16 D. an unexpected

17 C. complained

18 D. rude

19 B. unimportant

20 A. inquisitive

21. C. a complete surprise

22 D. loves to help people

23 D. had to survive on his own

24 D. very late

25 B. admitted he was wrong

26 B. accidentally

27 B. Completed

28 A. Violated

29 A. withheld

30 A. Funny

2019 BECE English Language Past Questions – Paper Two

PART A ESSAY WRITING

1. Write a letter to your headteacher discussing two games that should be encouraged among the students.
2. Write an article for publication in your school magazine on why every student should be computer-literate.
3. Write an interesting story which ends with the words, it pays to be kind to strangers

PART B COMPREHENSION

4. Read the following passage carefully and answer all the questions which follow

Friends are meant to help each other when the need arises. At school, some people develop friendly relationships which continue throughout their lives. One thing which helps people to stay together as intimate friends is the ability to communicate freely among themselves and endeavor to be each other's keeper. What destroys friendships mostly is friends being suspicious of each other. That is why a popular adage says, "Suspicion is the bane of friendship".

People attend school not only because they want to make friends but also to acquire knowledge and skills for employment. Education helps people to be polished in their manners. The school prepares its students to become useful citizens.

At school, Tono was not in the good books of the teachers because he behaved in an unruly manner. Initially, everyone avoided his company; he could be violent at times. Worst of all, he would refuse to do his assignment and was a habitual latecomer. With the passage of time, he was realized the need to work diligently in order to have a bright future. His academic work therefore improved by leaps and bounds.

Fortune separated us. I travelled abroad for further studies. I stayed away for two decades. On my return, I went to my former school for my certificate. There, I met a middle-age gentleman who also came to the office for the same purpose. I could not recognize him because time had

wiped off all memories of school. However, the names on the certificates revealed that we were classmates.

After further discussions, Tono invited me to be his business partner.

(a) (i) State one thing which helps people to be close.

(ii) How can friendships get destroyed?

(b) Give two reasons why people go to school.

(c) (i) Why did people avoid Tono's company?

(ii) State Tono's reason for visiting his former school.

(d) Why could the writer not recognize Tono?

(e) Explain, in your own words, give another word or a phrase that means the same, and can fit into the passage;

(i) Was not in the good books of teachers

(ii) With the passage of time

(iii) by leaps and bounds

(f) For each of the following words, give another word or phrase that means the same, and can fit into the passage:

(i) intimate;

(ii) adage;

(iii) acquire;

(iv) polished;

(v) initially

PART C LITERATURE

5. Question 5(a) to 5(c) are based on the abridged and simplified version of Charles Dickens' *Oliver Twist*

CHARLES DICKENS: *Oliver Twist*

"stop, thief!" he shouted, thinking Oliver had robbed him. The poor boy found himself being chased by people and even dogs! Someone in the crowd, a young man with purple lips and red sores all over his hands, grabbed Oliver and knocked him down..."

(Page 109)

(a) The one described as a young man with purple lips and red sores all over his hands is

(b) Why did the ‘young man with purple lips and red sores all over his hands’ want to harm Oliver?

(c) How did Mr. Brownlow help Oliver at the end of the story?

Read the following extract carefully and answer Questions 5(d) and 5(e)

KEN SARO-WIWA: *Home Sweet Home*

“Born, say, our young Miss has arrived heavily laden with all the good things of this earth. I should think Dukana will soon float on a sea of wealth”

(Page 178)

(d) Who is referred to as our young Miss?

(e) The library device used in heavily laden with all the good things of the earth is.....

Read the following extract carefully and answer Questions 5(f) to 5(h)

AMA ATA AIDOO: *The Dilemma of a Ghost*

“X: It was a couple of days ago that we met. What came out of the meeting is that we must come and ask you and your wife what is preventing you from giving your grandmother a great-grandchild before she leaves us.”

(Act 4, Page 66)

(f) The speaker represented by ‘X’ in the extract is.....

(g) According to Ato, what is preventing him and his wife from having children?

(h) The figure of speech that describes she leaves us in the extract is.....

Read the following extract carefully and answer Question 5(i) and 5(j)

THERESA ENNIN: *Makola*

“Head bent, rags all around the upside down pan
Picking her nose, shuffling her feet, oblivious to the bustle”

(Page 158)

(i) Write one group of words in the extract that brings out the theme of uncleanliness.

(j) The words Head bent, rags all around the upside down pan appeal to the reader’s sense of.....

Comprehension Answers

- (a) (i) People's ability to communicate freely among themselves and being each others' keepers.
- (ii) Friendships are destroyed when friends get suspicious of each other.

- (b) (i). To acquire skills for employment.
- (ii) To make friends

- (c) (i) He could be violent at times. / He behaved badly. / He was disliked by his teachers.
- (ii) Tono visited his former school in order to collect his certificate.

- (d) He had not seen Tono in over two decades.

- (e) Explain, in your own words, give another word or a phrase that means the same, and can fit into the passage;

- (i) was not in the good books of teachers – The teachers were displeased with his behaviour
- (ii) with the passage of time – As time proceeded.
- (iii) by leaps and bounds – tremendously /Rapidly / swiftly/quickly

- (f) For each of the following words, give another word or phrase that means the same, and can fit into the passage:

- (i) intimate – very close / dear
- (ii) adage – proverb / saying
- (iii) acquire – obtain / gain
- (iv) polished – refined / fine-tuned
- (v) initially – From the start / At first / in the beginning

Literature answers

- (a) Monks / Edward Leeford
- (b) He intended to keep all of their father's wealth to himself.
- (c) He helped Oliver Twist discover who his real parents were.
- (d) The Author
- (e) Hyperbole
- (f) Petu

(g) An unknown reason / Nothing

(h) Euphemism

(i) Rags all around

(j) sight / sympathy